

Matthias Haslberger

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Born: April 2, 1994—Ingolstadt, Germany
Nationality: German

Research Interests

Political economy of structural change; AI, automation, and the future of work; the governance of skills and vocational training; social policy and inequality.

Academic Appointments

- 2026–2027 **John F. Kennedy Memorial Fellow**, Minda de Gunzburg Center for European Studies (CES), Harvard University
Project: Determinants of Skill Demand in the AI Economy
- 2022–2026 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, Chair of Comparative Political Economy, School of Economics and Political Science, **University of St. Gallen**
Project: Governance in Vocational and Professional Education and Training ([GOVPET](#))
PI: Patrick Emmenegger, Professor of Comparative Political Economy
- 2021–2022 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, Department of Politics and International Relations (DPIR) and Nuffield College, **University of Oxford**
Project: The Politics of Wealth Inequality ([WEALTHPOL](#))
PI: Ben Ansell, Professor of Comparative Democratic Institutions

Education

- 2017–2022 **DPhil in Social Policy**, Department of Social Policy and Intervention (DSPI) and Nuffield College, **University of Oxford**
Defended Jan 2022; degree awarded Jul 2022.
Co-advisors: Erzsebet Bukodi and Brian Nolan
Thesis: *‘Technological Change and Labour Market Institutions and Their Effect on Employment, Wages, and Inequality’*

2016–2017	MSc in Comparative Social Policy , DSPI and Kellogg College, University of Oxford Final grade: Distinction Thesis: <i>Labour Market Institutions and Wage Inequality</i>
2012–2016	BA in Liberal Arts and Sciences , University of Freiburg Final grade: 1.2/Excellent
2014	EXCHANGE SEMESTER at the Schreyer Honors College, Pennsylvania State University GPA 3.93/4.0

Publications & Talks

ARTICLES IN PEER-REVIEWED JOURNALS

Emmenegger, P., **Haslberger, M.**, and Wilson, A. 2026. ‘Caught in a Downward Spiral? The Relative Attractiveness Deficit of Vocational Education and Training.’ *Sociology of Education*.

Haslberger, M., Emmenegger, P., and Durazzi, N. 2026. ‘The Missing Link: Technological Change, Dual VET, and Social Policy Preferences.’ *British Journal of Political Science*.

Haslberger, M., Elkjær, M., and Ansell, B. 2026. ‘Homeownership and Political Efficacy: How Housing Wealth Shapes Whether People Feel Heard.’ *West European Politics*.

Haslberger, M., Gingrich, J., and Bhatia, J. 2025. ‘Rage Against the Machine? Generative AI Exposure, Subjective Risk, and Policy Preferences.’ *Journal of European Public Policy*.

Emmenegger, P. and **Haslberger, M.** 2025. ‘Yesterday’s Model for Tomorrow’s Economy? Dual VET and Wage Inequality in the Knowledge Economy.’ *Journal of European Social Policy* 36(2), 185–198.

Haslberger, M. and Bajka, S. M. 2025. ‘Subjective Technology Risk and Education Preferences: VET as a Safe Haven or Dead End?’ *Regulation & Governance* 20(2), 621–634.

Elkjær, M. A., Ansell, B., Bokobza, L., Cansunar, A., **Haslberger, M.**, and Nystrup, J. 2025. ‘Why Is It So Hard to Counteract Wealth Inequality? Evidence from the United Kingdom.’ *World Politics* 77(3), 515–561.

Giudici, A., Gingrich, J., Chevalier, T., and **Haslberger, M.** 2023. ‘Center-right Parties and Post-War Secondary Education.’ *Comparative Politics* 55(2), 193–218.

Haslberger, M. 2022. ‘Rethinking the measurement of occupational task content.’ *The Economic and Labour Relations Review* 33(1), 178–199.

Haslberger, M. 2021. ‘Routine-biased technological change does not always lead to polarisation: Evidence from 10 OECD countries, 1995–2013.’ *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility* 74(4), Article 100623.

ARTICLES UNDER REVIEW

Haslberger, M., Gingrich, J., and Bhatia, J. ‘No Great Equalizer: Experimental Evidence on Productivity Effects of Generative AI Use in the UK Labor Market.’ Invited to resubmit at *Research Policy*.

Haslberger, M., Elkjær, M., and Ansell, B. ‘The Electoral Politics of Wealth Taxation: Housing, Information, and Public Opinion.’ Revise and resubmit at *Socio-Economic Review*.

WORK IN PROGRESS

‘Artificial Intelligence, Voice at Work, and Politics’

‘The New Politics of Artificial Intelligence’ (*with Aina Gallego, Thomas Kurer, and Nicole Wu*)

‘How Do People Reason About Policy Responses to Generative AI?’ (*with Jasmine Bhatia, Patrick Emmenegger, and Jane Gingrich*)

‘Obtaining Validated and Nuanced Occupational Information in Online Surveys’

‘Striking the Balance? Firms’ Training Strategies in Response to Generative AI’

‘Perceptions of Inequality in Europe’ (*with Mads Elkjær*)

‘Housing Wealth and Tax Mix Preferences’ (*with Mads Elkjær*)

‘VET Systems and Socio-Economic Outcomes’ (*with Patrick Emmenegger*)

‘Artificial Intelligence in Vocational Education: The Dual Role of Vocational Teachers’ (*with Sabine Seufert and Patrick Emmenegger*)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026	APSA (Boston), EPSS (Belfast), MPSA (Chicago), In_equality Conference (Konstanz), SPSA (Zurich)
2025	DPSA (Nyborg), APSA (Vancouver), EPSA (Madrid), ECPR Joint Sessions (Prague), SPSA (Geneva)
2024	LCSSP AI Conference (Pasadena), CES (Lyon), SASE (Limerick), VPET-ECON (Zurich), VALURED Conference (St. Gallen), In_equality Conference (Konstanz), SPSA (St. Gallen)
2023	ESPAnet (Warsaw), RC28 Summer Meeting (Ann Arbor), CES (Reykjavik), EPSA (Glasgow), SPSA (Basel)
2022	APSA (Montreal), EPSA (Prague), RC28 Spring Meeting (London)
2021	RC28 Summer Meeting (virtual), ISA Forum of Sociology (virtual)
2020	EALE SOLE AASLE World Conference (virtual), ECSR (virtual)
2019	RC28 Summer Meeting (Princeton), ECSR (Lausanne)
2018	ECSR (Paris)

RECENT INVITED TALKS & WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

2026	European Consortium for Political Research Headquarters, Bilkent University
2025	University of Basel, Nuffield College (University of Oxford), European Forum Alpbach, SERI VET Conference, University of St. Gallen
2024	Vienna University of Economics and Business, University of Konstanz, University of St. Gallen, Yale University, OECD Future of Work Programme, University of Freiburg
2023	Zurich Political Economy Seminar Series
2022	University of St. Gallen, Bundesinstitut für Berufsbildung Bonn (BIBB), Nuffield College (University of Oxford), Junge Akademie Mainz, University of Lausanne, Social Inequalities Research Group (University of Oxford)

Teaching

Spring 2026	INTEGRATIVE PROJECT, Policy advisory seminar, Bachelor in Business Administration, University of St. Gallen
Spring 2025	INTEGRATIVE PROJECT, Policy advisory seminar, Bachelor in Business Administration, University of St. Gallen
Fall 2024	INTRODUCTION TO QUANTITATIVE METHODS, Seminar, Bachelor in International Affairs, University of St. Gallen
Fall 2022	THE FUTURE OF WORK, Lecture and seminar, Master's Programme in International Affairs and Governance, University of St. Gallen

Grants, Awards & Scholarships

MAJOR GRANTS

May 2025	Workshop Funding from Nuffield College, Oxford, for a workshop “The Politics of AI: Citizen Perceptions, Preferences, and Priorities” (with Ben Ansell; £7,000)
Aug 2024	CIFAR Catalyst Grant “ChatGPT and Changing Labor Markets” (with Jane Gingrich, Jasmine Bhatia, and Patrick Emmenegger; CAD 50,000)
Mar 2024	Green Box Programmförderung by the University of St. Gallen for a survey on the politics of generative AI (CHF 10,000)
Feb 2024	ZENiT Zukunftskolleg funding for research on the politics of AI (with Tobias Tober; € 45,000)
Jul 2023	Project Funding from the University of Oxford (with Jane Gingrich and Jasmine Bhatia; £15,000)

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- 2023 **Associate Member of Nuffield College**, elected for a 3-year term in December 2023
- 2017 **Barnett House-Nuffield Joint Graduate Scholarship in Social Policy** covering three years of tuition fees and a living grant for doctoral study at Nuffield College and the Department of Social Policy and Intervention, University of Oxford (*approximately £90,000*)
- 2017 **George Smith Award** for the best MSc thesis in the academic year 2016–2017 at the Department of Social Policy and Intervention, University of Oxford

Service

Guest Editor for a special issue on “The Politics of AI: Citizen Perceptions, Preferences, and Priorities” in *Comparative Political Studies*.

Organiser of the Nuffield Politics of AI Workshop (2025), ZENiT Politics of AI Workshop (2026, 2024) and GOVPET PhD Workshop (2024, 2023).

Panel Organiser at the following conferences: EPSS 2026, APSA 2025, EPSA 2025, SASE 2024, EPSA 2023.

Selection Committee for the Best Paper Award of the APSA Education Politics Section (2024).

Reviewer contributions (selection): American Journal of Political Science, American Sociological Review, British Journal of Political Science, Comparative Politics, Electoral Studies, European Journal of Political Research, European Political Science Review, European Sociological Review, ILR Review, Journal of European Public Policy, Journal of European Social Policy, Journal of Politics, Political Geography, Research in Social Stratification and Mobility, Socio-Economic Review, World Politics.

Nuffield College: Boat Club Secretary (2019–2021), Boat Club Captain (2018–2019), Student Common Room President (2018/2019), Social Secretary (2017/2018).

Professional Skills

LANGUAGES

GERMAN (native), ENGLISH (fluent), FRENCH (intermediate), SPANISH (intermediate), ARABIC (beginner), MANDARIN (beginner)

SOFTWARE

R, Stata, LaTeX, MATLAB, Python

ADDITIONAL METHODS TRAINING (SELECTION)

Jul–Aug ‘23	Advanced Survey Data Analysis and Survey Experiments <i>Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis</i>
Jun ‘23	Introduction to Machine Learning with R <i>GSERM Global Summer School in Empirical Research Methods, St. Gallen</i>
Jul–Aug ‘18	Panel Data Analysis for Comparative Research <i>Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis</i>
Jul–Aug ‘18	Mathematics for Social Scientists Part 2 <i>Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis</i>
Jan–Mar ‘18	Causality <i>Department of Sociology, University of Oxford</i>
Oct–Dec ‘17	Advanced Econometrics <i>Department of Economics, University of Oxford</i>
Apr–Jun ‘17	Panel Data Analysis <i>DPIR, University of Oxford</i>
Apr–Jun ‘17	Advances in Causal Inference <i>DPIR, University of Oxford</i>
Jan–Mar ‘17	Intermediate Social Statistics <i>DPIR, University of Oxford</i>

Last updated: September 8, 2026